



C SHANMUGAR

KERALA POLICE ON PATROL IN A HIRED FISHING TRAWLER; (BELOW) ARRESTED LET OPERATIVE MOHAMMAD OMAR MADNI ENTERED INDIA ON A RECRUITMENT DRIVE

than 1,500 tech firms employing two lakh workers. Any attack will thus ensure instant global attention. With two terror strikes in four years and threats of more attacks, the security of India's Silicon Valley now rests with a 100-man army commando unit based in Benson Town area. This is because the Karnataka Police is in no shape. "My Government will give top priority to the state security apparatus," said Karnataka Chief Minister Yeddyurappa, but the facts on the ground belie his statement. Under a Rs 97-crore modernisation plan for its police force last year, Karnataka planned for 100 GPS-equipped police jeeps for Bangalore and 500 vehicles for the coastal and Naxal affected regions. The police has asked for BPJs, bomb disposal squads and permanent relief teams but there is no sign of these vehicles or equipment.

The city police's dog squads have been trained only to sniff out older explosive like gelatin rather than more modern explosives like RDX. The state disaster management cell functions under the revenue department instead of the chief minister's office. The police force is yet to be trained and equipped with modern assault rifles and intelligence is still being used to spy on political rivals rather than penetrating radical groups. The state anti-terrorist cell has been headless since the incumbent retired on May 31. This despite security agencies unearthing several sleeper cells in the city over the past decade and specific warnings of terrorists targeting the Vidhana Soudha. Last month, a worried city police submitted to the state Government, a 51-point proposal to fortify the Assembly. These include installing pop-up tyre killers (to deflate the tyres of intruding vehicles) and vehicle scanner machines. The proposal is yet to be cleared even as another strike looms large.

with Bhavna Vij-Aurora and Stephen David

INTELLIGENCE SHARING

FLAW No sharing of intelligence prior to 26/11 attacks. MAC defunct.

SOLUTION Getting agencies to share intelligence through MAC

STORY SO FAR MAC works 24x7, but has a long way to go

6/10

Following the home minister's diktat, the multi agency centre (MAC) run by the IB, which coordinates intelligence sharing between 22 intelligence agencies, has been rejuvenated in the past seven months. Most of the agencies are, for the first time, sharing intelligence with the MAC. Threats are assessed and the agencies concerned are alerted. The Home Ministry has set up 30 subsidiary MACs in state capitals but is yet to activate the National Intelligence Grid which will mark real-time sharing of intelligence. There are complaints of delays and lack of communication with other agencies, but the MAC is perhaps the only bright spot in the otherwise dismal story of intelligence sharing.

YASBANT NEGI



THREAT TO BANGALORE

FLAW State police units are under-equipped, lack strike power

SOLUTION Karnataka must create anti-terror cells

STORY SO FAR State is yet to take basic anti-terror steps

2/10

Bangalore is a soft target because it contributes nearly 40 per cent to India's IT revenues of Rs 67,000 crore in fiscal 2009. The city houses more